



◀ THE CENTRAL COURTYARD AND POOL OF THE ALI BEN YOUSSEF MADRASA

Emperor Askia Mohamed, after he declared Gao the capital of the Songhai Empire and made Islam the empire's official religion. The tower—the tomb itself, where the emperor is thought to be buried—is an earthen structure made using the region's traditional mud-building techniques and featuring permanent wooden scaffolding. It also functions as a minaret. The monument has been severely damaged due to erosion and political conflicts. It was designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2004.

Ali Ben Youssef Madrasa

Location Marrakech, Morocco

Built in the 14th century, the Ali Ben Youssef Madrasa was enlarged and redecorated in 1570, becoming one of the most architecturally distinguished and largest Islamic colleges of the Maghreb region of North Africa. At one point, its 132 rooms housed up to 900 students. The structure, which is influenced by Andalusian architecture, is delicately decorated with cedar wood and mosaic carvings, colorful tiles, and stucco inscriptions. A large marble courtyard, 50 ft (15 m) wide and 65 ft (20 m) long, is bordered by open-air galleries on its east and west sides, and a pool sits at its center. The *madrasa's* prayer room is capped by a heavily ornate, wooden dome. In the 1960s, the building was transformed into a museum.

Tomb of Askia

Location Gao, Mali

The Tomb of Askia is part of a key building complex in the Malian city of Gao. It comprises a pyramidal tower, two flat-roofed mosques, a necropolis, and a white stone square. The 56-ft- (17-m-) high pyramid was created in 1495 by the

many of the buildings of Asmara, which was developed in the 1890s as an Italian colony. It was originally designed in 1920 by Ernesto Gallo, but the structure was replaced, in 1939, by the current cathedral, whose architect is unknown. The structure consists of a main body flanked by two imposing towers built in alternate layers of brick and stone, reflecting the local Aksumite architecture. The central facade features brightly colored murals.

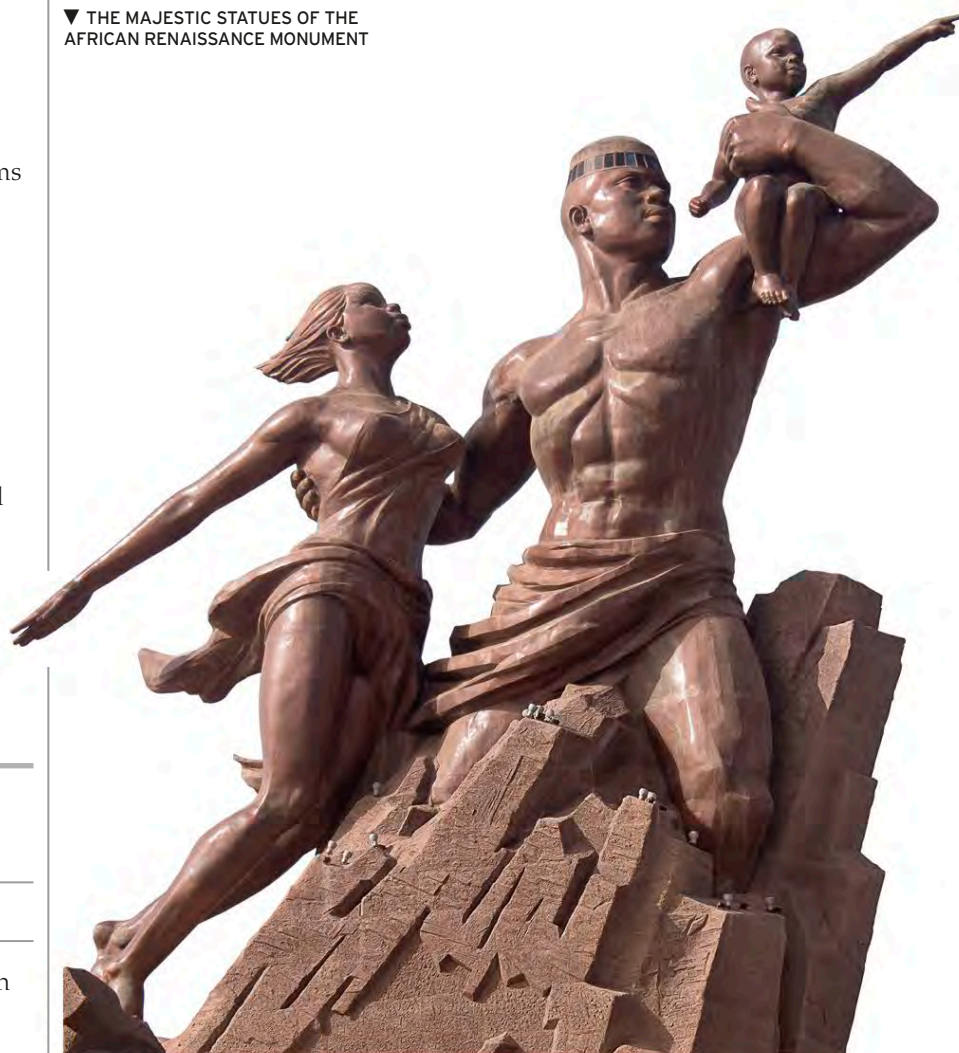
African Renaissance Monument

Location Dakar, Senegal

Designed by the Senegalese architect Pierre Goudiaby and completed in 2010, the

▼ THE MAJESTIC STATUES OF THE AFRICAN RENAISSANCE MONUMENT

African Renaissance Monument was built to commemorate Senegal's 50 years of independence from France. It is a bronze statue that sits at the summit of one of the twin hills of Collines des Mamelles, overlooking the Atlantic. The project was spearheaded by the country's then-president Abdoulaye Wade and was conceived as a celebration of a new era for Africa. The dynamic composition, consisting of a man, a woman, and a child, can be approached by a dramatic series of steps. At 160 ft (49 m) high, it dominates the Dakar skyline and is thought to be the tallest statue in Africa. An observation deck, in the head of the male figure, offers spectacular views of the Atlantic Ocean.



Enda Mariam Orthodox Cathedral

Location Asmara, Eritrea

The architecture of this Eritrean Orthodox church reflects the distinct Modernist style of